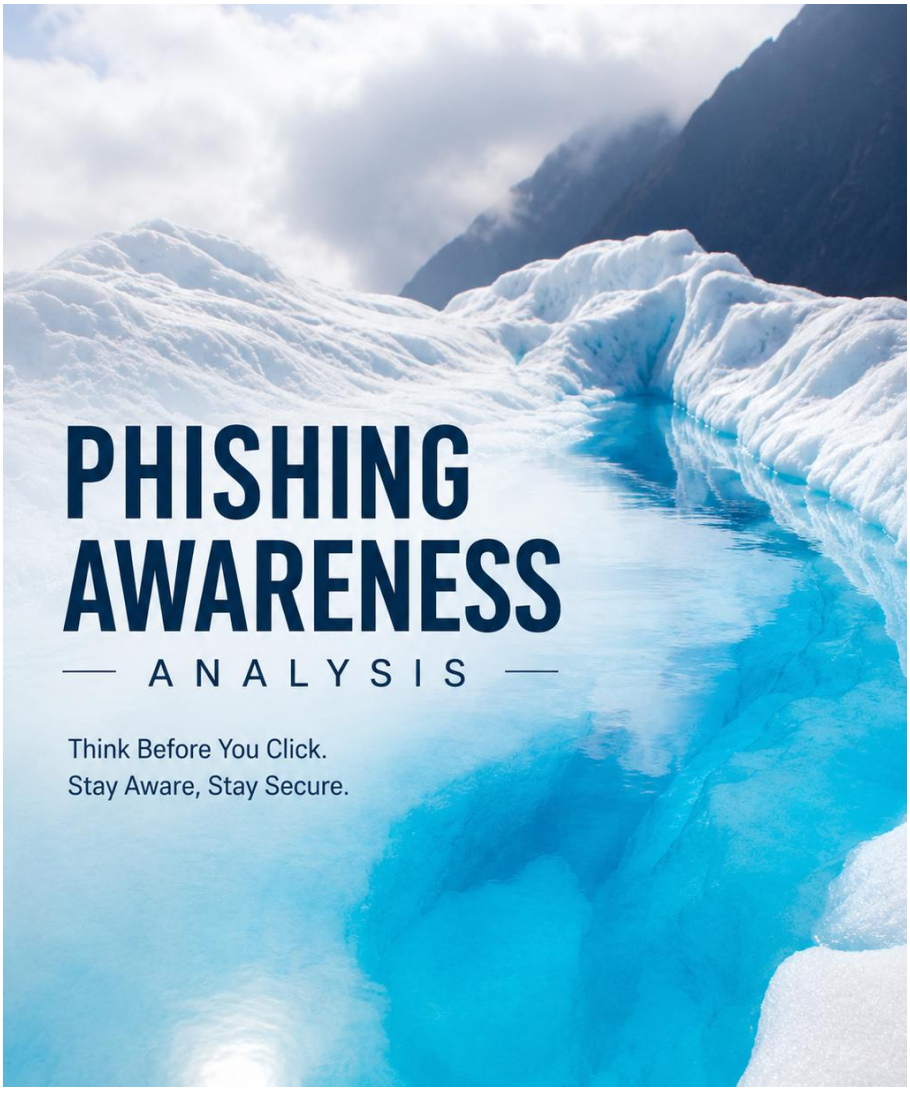
PROJECT 3
PHISHING AWARENESS ANALYSIS



Submitted by
Aymen Altaf

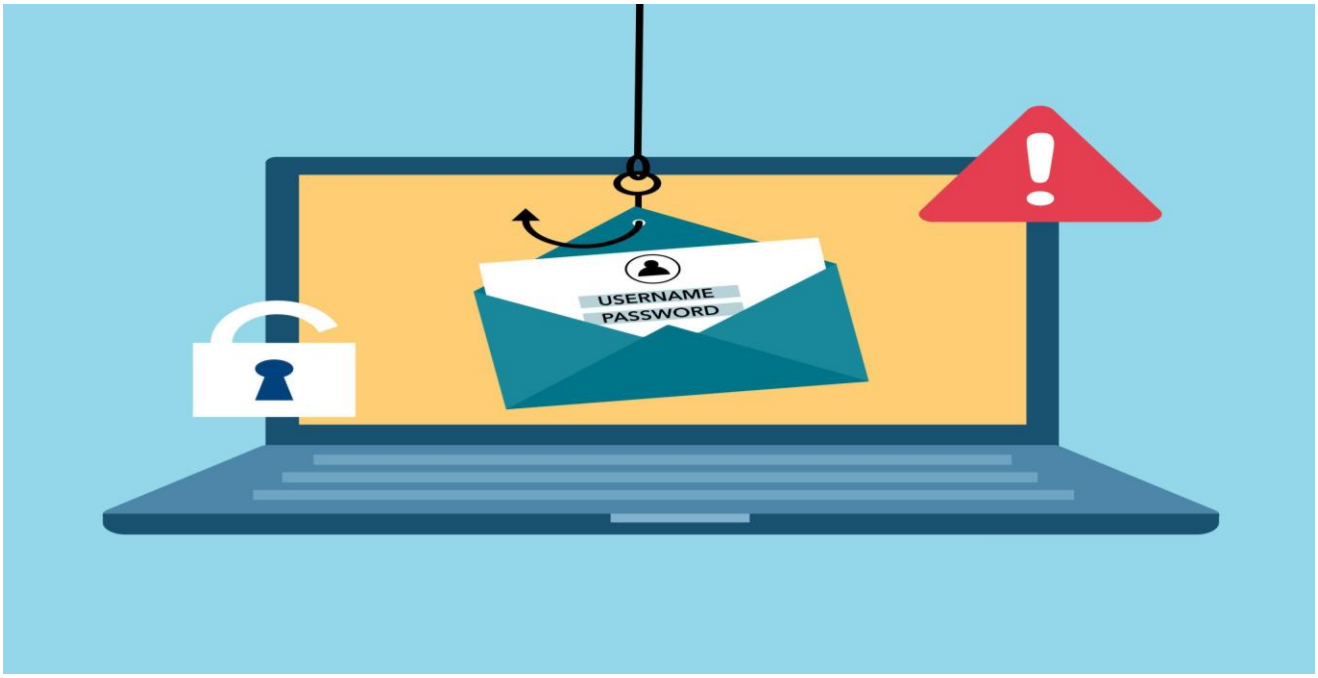


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Introduction

This report analyzes phishing emails to identify malicious indicators including fake links, urgency tactics, spoofed identities and credential harvesting attempts, following the DecodeLabs Project 3 requirements.

Objectives

• Identify phishing attempts
• Detect suspicious links and keywords
• Explain why messages are unsafe
• Improve security awareness

What is Phishing?

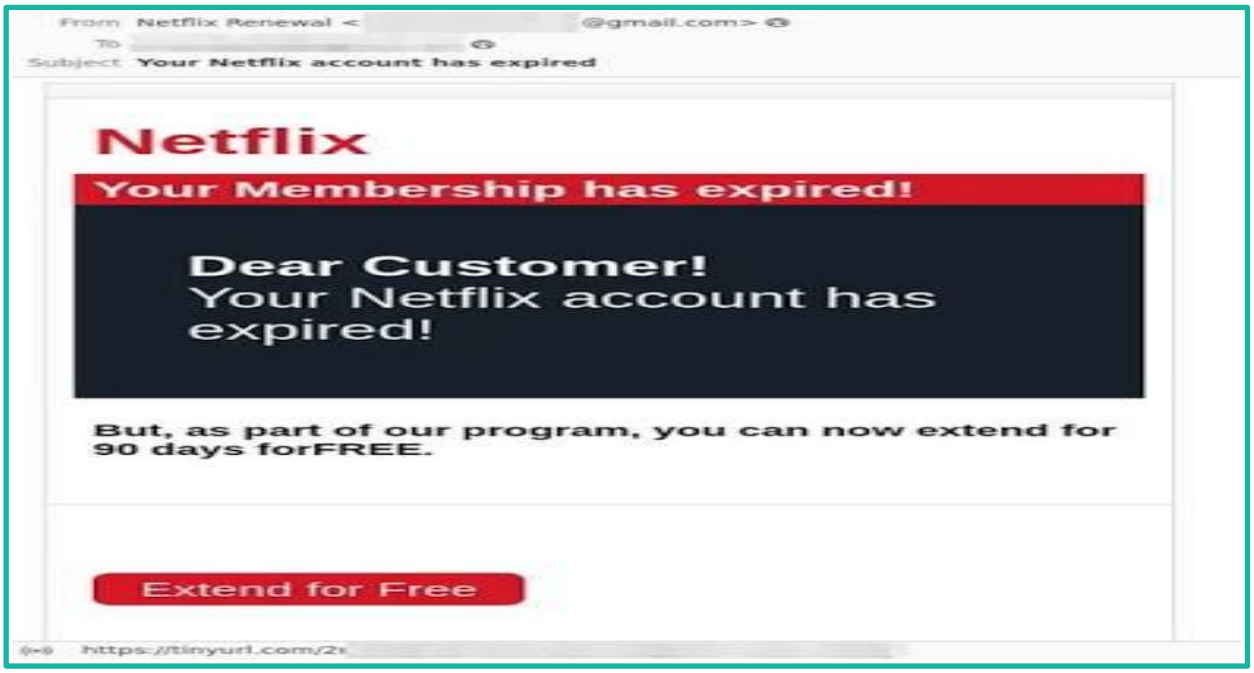
Phishing is a social engineering attack that tricks users into revealing sensitive information through fraudulent emails, messages or websites.

Common Types of Phishing

- Email Phishing
- Spear Phishing
- Smishing
- Vishing
- Clone Phishing
- Business Email Compromise

Case Study 1

Subject: Netflix Subscription Expired

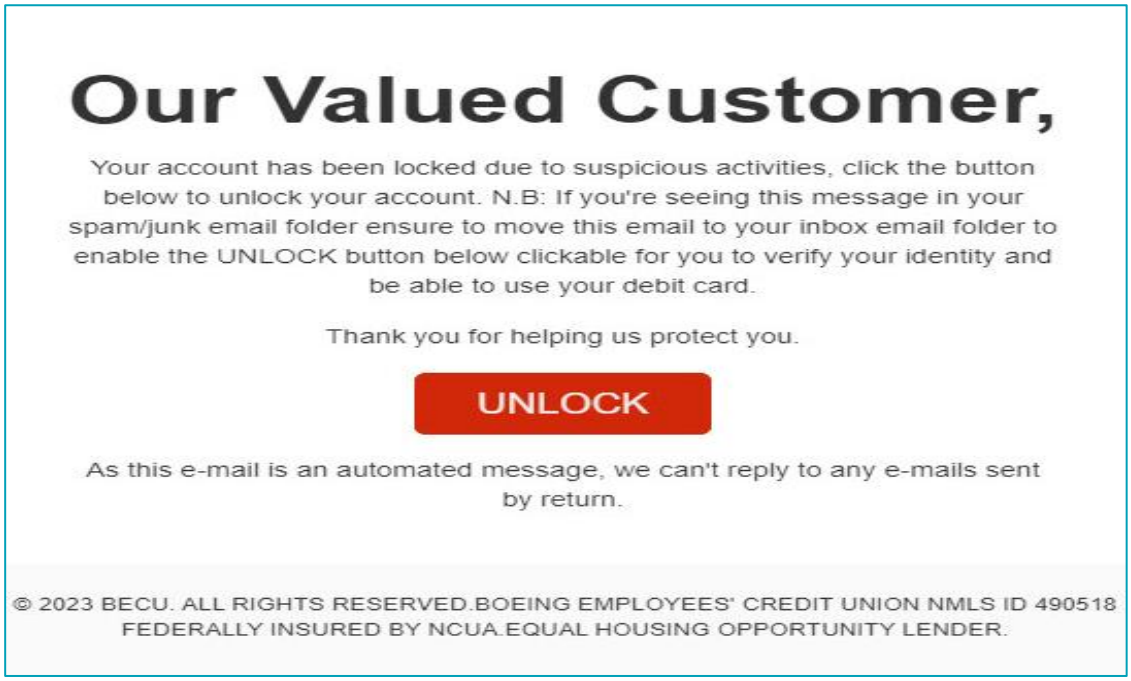


Red Flags	Risk
Urgency, fake domain, login request.	Credentials stolen.

Recommendation: Verify the sender, inspect URLs, avoid clicking suspicious links, and report the email.

Case Study 2

Subject: Bank Account Locked



Our Valued Customer,

Your account has been locked due to suspicious activities, click the button below to unlock your account. N.B: If you're seeing this message in your spam/junk email folder ensure to move this email to your inbox email folder to enable the UNLOCK button below clickable for you to verify your identity and be able to use your debit card.

Thank you for helping us protect you.

UNLOCK

As this e-mail is an automated message, we can't reply to any e-mails sent by return.

© 2023 BECU. ALL RIGHTS RESERVED.BOEING EMPLOYEES' CREDIT UNION NMLS ID 490518
FEDERALLY INSURED BY NCUA.EQUAL HOUSING OPPORTUNITY LENDER.

Red Flags	Risk
Threatens account lock, fake verification.	Financial theft.

Recommendation: Verify the sender, inspect URLs, avoid clicking suspicious links, and report the email.

Case Study 3

Subject: Free iPhone Winner

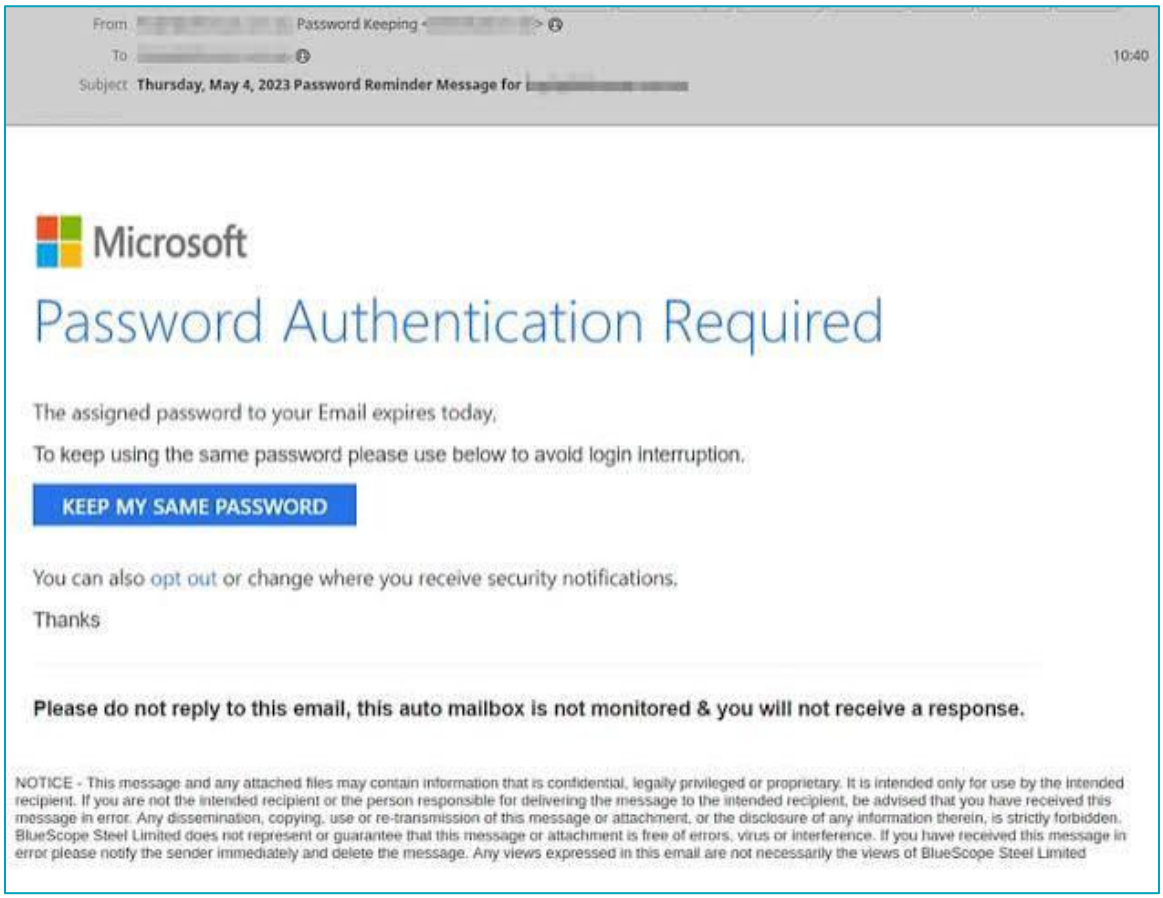


Red Flags	Risk
Prize scam, unknown sender.	Personal data theft.

Recommendation: Verify the sender, inspect URLs, avoid clicking suspicious links, and report the email.

Case Study 4

Subject: Microsoft Password Reset

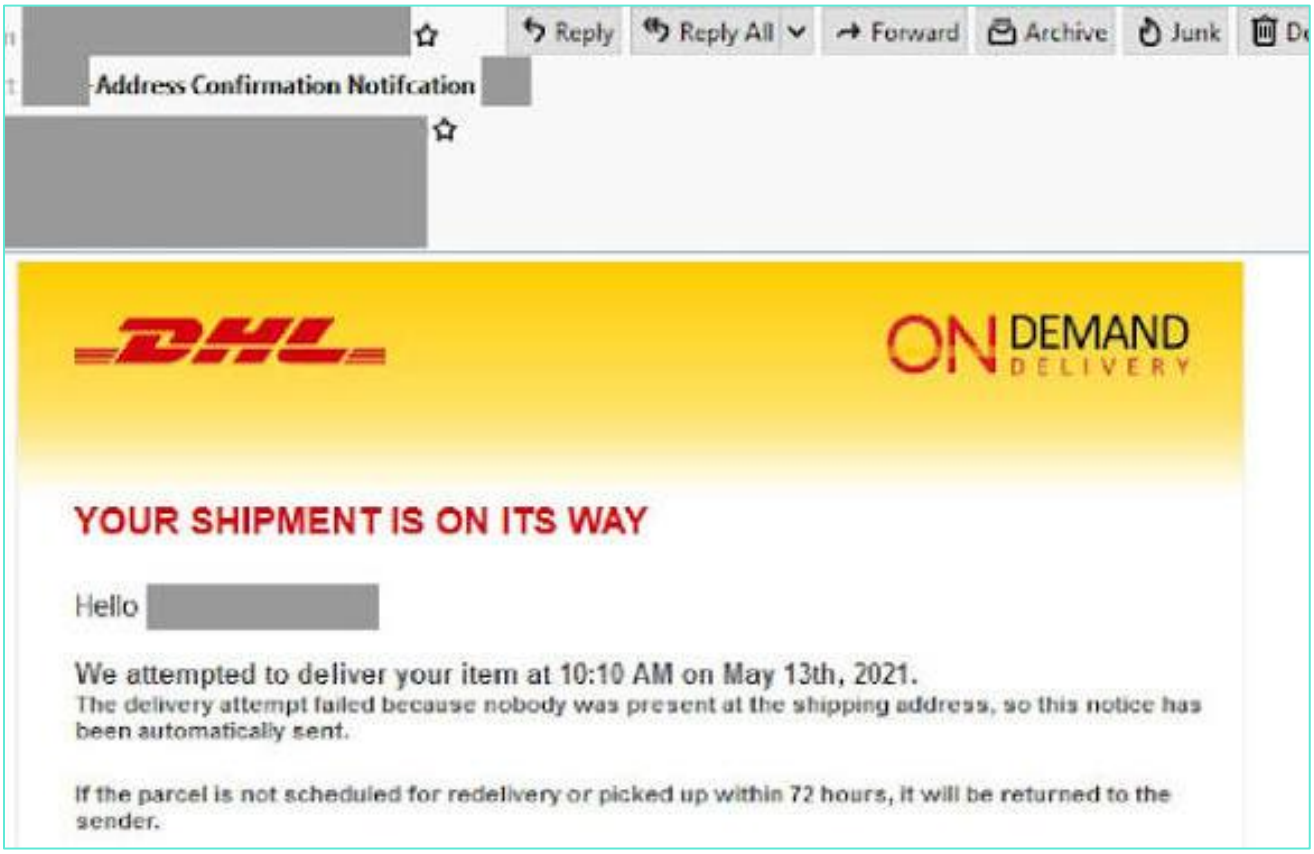


Red Flags	Risk
Fake Microsoft page.	Account compromise.

Recommendation: Verify the sender, inspect URLs, avoid clicking suspicious links, and report the email.

Case Study 5

Subject: Package Delivery Failed



Red Flags	Risk
Fake courier link.	Identity theft.

Recommendation: Verify the sender, inspect URLs, avoid clicking suspicious links, and report the email.

Phishing Red Flag Checklist

- Unknown sender
- Misspelled domains
- Urgent requests
- Password/OTP requests
- Unexpected attachments
- Grammar mistakes
- Generic greeting
- Suspicious hyperlinks
- Too-good-to-be-true offers
- Unverified contact information

Security Best Practices

• Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

• Use strong passwords

• Keep software updated

• Verify websites before logging in

• Report suspicious emails

• Use antivirus software

• Never share OTPs.

Conclusion

Phishing attacks exploit human psychology more than technology. Recognizing warning signs such as fake domains, urgency, and requests for confidential

information helps prevent compromise. Security awareness remains one of the strongest defenses against phishing attacks.

References

- DecodeLabs Project 3 Guidelines
- CISA Phishing Guidance
- NIST Cybersecurity Awareness Resources